

George Pendapala Natangwe Nekwaya

Fintech and Payments · Open Banking · Platforms · Hospitality Technology

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Fintech and payments consultant with an engineering foundation and a Master of Business Administration in Data Analytics, Strategy and Innovation, specialised in Open Banking and Platforms. Founder of Checkpoint by Buffr, a live privacy-first guest and visitor check-in platform for Namibian hospitality, and builder of the operating software for the family business, Hotel Etuna in Ongwediva. Builds applications across fintech, payments and analytics, and works on regulatory-intelligence agents and knowledge-graph and retrieval-augmented generation systems. Consults for Ketchup Software Solutions, which supports NamPost's pension grant disbursements. Brings research-backed command of Namibia's payment regulatory landscape, grounded in case-study work on global payment infrastructure (cross-border interlinking, multi-central-bank digital currency settlement, programmable money and platform economics), to bridge technology, strategy and social impact.

EXPERIENCE**Founder, Buffr Financial Services CC**

2024 to present

Windhoek, Namibia

Checkpoint by Buffr (buffrcheckpoint.com)

- Designed, built and launched a guest and visitor check-in platform live in production: quick response code check-in on the guest's own phone, receptionist-assisted entry, an optional offline Android reception tablet and near-field communication badges.
- Architected its privacy model: one encrypted record per guest, role-based access by property and site, a hash-linked audit trail and mandatory two-step sign-in for platform staff.
- Built per-site subscription billing with invoicing, proof-of-payment confirmation and payment-gated go-live; set the Site, Network and Assure pricing.
- Built the CiMSO INNterchange integration that brings expected arrivals from a lodge's booking system into Checkpoint.
- Leads the first pilot at Hotel Etuna, Ongwediva, and the partnerships strategy with the hospitality sector.

Buffr, Your Payment Companion (buffr.ai)

An intuitive digital wallet for young adults in Southern Africa. Tracks financial health and habits, and takes consent-based actions such as creating wallets, requesting funds from contacts and making payments, guarded by multi-factor authentication. Includes artificial intelligence financial guidance, NAMQR and peer-to-peer payments, purpose-built wallets, credit building from transactions, and rewards.

Technology and Strategy, Hotel Etuna

2026 to present

Family business, formerly Etuna Guesthouse and Tours · Ongwediva, Namibia

- Building the hotel's operating software, covering bookings, a guest portal, digital check-in and check-out, restaurant orders, guest communications and accounting, with guest privacy controls built in.

- Contributes strategy to the brand repositioning from Etuna Guesthouse and Tours to Hotel Etuna.

Fintech and Payments Consultant, Ketchup Software Solutions

January 2026 to present

Windhoek, Namibia

- Conducts regulatory analysis across payments, telecommunications and financial services to shape the product and licensing roadmap.
- Designed Proof-of-Life-as-a-Service, a biometric verification layer confirming living, eligible beneficiaries before a grant payment.
- Proposed an agent-network model on biometric verification, enabling NamPost to extend services beyond existing branches.
- Developing an artificial-intelligence-powered field operations platform for paymaster teams.
- Led organisational investigations and change management, supporting governance and policy framework development.

Independent Fintech Research and Development

2023 to present

Self-directed · Massachusetts, United States and Windhoek, Namibia

- Service-landscape analysis for NamPost: designed an open banking architecture aligned with the Banking Industry Architecture Network to modernise legacy infrastructure.
- Investigating computational governance, policy sludge and compliance harmonisation.
- Comparative study of five international regulatory sandboxes (United Kingdom Financial Conduct Authority, Monetary Authority of Singapore, Australian Securities and Investments Commission, Abu Dhabi Global Market and Hong Kong Monetary Authority) and the NayaOne digital sandbox model, distilling design lessons for a Namibian national sandbox.
- Architected a proof-of-life and benefits eligibility platform for government-to-person disbursement integrity, including biometric enrolment, identity verification and consent-first registration.
- Built a Financial Analyst Agent: a knowledge-graph and retrieval-augmented generation system producing structured competitive and regulatory intelligence on Namibia's top four banks and NamPost.
- Studied near-instant payments in the field, including engagement with India's Unified Payments Interface ecosystem and India Stack architecture.
- Investigating instant payment system operators and service providers across Africa, including AfricaNenda's State of Inclusive Instant Payment Systems 2025 assessment of live rails, the Inclusivity Spectrum scorecard, and how central banks and operators measure reach, trust architecture and oversight.
- Case-study analysis of Bank for International Settlements Innovation Hub and Monetary Authority of Singapore payment-innovation initiatives (Project Nexus, Project Dunbar, Project Orchid) and Rwanda's National Digital Payments System, completed within the Rearchitecting the Financial System programme.
- Completed the Open Banking and Platforms in Finance Specialisation (five courses): platform and ecosystem business models, embedded finance and super apps, Open Banking data-monetisation strategies, and the regulatory and investment implications of Open Banking.
- Completed the Online Certificate for Fintech in Africa: seven masterclasses and six industry-insight sessions spanning fintech, artificial intelligence, blockchain, regulatory technology, payments, Open Banking and sustainability.
- Authored an analysis of Stripe's payment processing strategy across Southern African Development Community mobile payment markets.

- Engaged with the global fintech community at the MIT Fintech Conference (2024 and 2025), Fintech Junction (Tel Aviv, 2023) and Black in E-Commerce (Atlanta, 2023).

Project Manager, The Alliance for Climate Transition

October 2024 to June 2025

Massachusetts, United States · joinact.org

- Led workforce development assessments in partnership with the Massachusetts Clean Energy Center.
- Interviewed organisations ranging from start-ups to Fortune 500 companies to analyse clean-energy hiring needs, and developed diversity and inclusion strategies.
- Authored a workforce development assessment report with actionable recommendations for regional stakeholders.
- Built the first version of the Alliance's Climate Economy Careers Platform, featuring resume analysis, skills-gap assessment and Massachusetts climate economy knowledge.

Business Development Consultant, Aquasaic Corporation

Concurrent with the Alliance

- Conducted commercial and technical research on water treatment technologies.
- Developed pitch decks and materials to support funding initiatives across various sectors.
- Supported web development and strategic consulting engagements.

Business Development Intern, Insait IO (now Encore)

June to July 2023

Tel Aviv, Israel · gainencore.ai

- Conducted data analysis for Valley National Bank and tracked emerging fintech trends including NayaOne and Pecan AI.
- Investigated European Union artificial intelligence Act and United States regulatory compliance considerations for artificial intelligence in finance.
- Developed and presented a strategy and compliance framework for artificial intelligence in banking, covering artificial intelligence ethics and systemic risk.

International Sales Representative, KANIE Distribution and Supply Chain

2020 to 2021

Windhoek, Namibia

- Represented KANIE at Dubai Expo 2020.
- Presented technical solutions at Namibia's 4th Industrial Revolution Expo.
- Provided training to government officials on drone applications.

Business Operations Manager, Polar Power Namibia

June 2017 to August 2020

Windhoek, Namibia

- Constructed ten telecommunications towers for Mobile Telecommunications Limited aligned with Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia standards.
- Secured a contract to design and deliver two portable wireless trailer masts to BoFiNet (Botswana); established partnerships with MTN Business, NECOR Ltd (Zambia) and Victoria Consolidated (Tanzania).

Assistant Site Agent, Namibia Road Products and Services

2017 to 2018

Windhoek, Namibia

- Led road construction operations and stakeholder engagement in Windhoek.

Civil Engineering Intern, Lithon Project Consultants

2016 to 2018

Ongwediva, Namibia

- Assisted with civil engineering projects, site visits, tender document evaluation and administrative tasks.

EDUCATION

Brandeis International Business School

2024

Master of Business Administration (designated in science, technology, engineering and mathematics), Data Analytics, Strategy and Innovation · Waltham, Massachusetts, United States

- Founded Buffr: winner of the 2023 Asper Student Startup Prize; accepted into the MassChallenge, Global Venture Labs and Brandeis Spark accelerator cohorts.
- Vice President, International Business School Student Association; led the Association to "2023 Student Group of the Year" recognition.
- Graduate Student Senator and Board Member, Graduate Student Association.
- Instructional Assistant, Social Impact Investing and Master of Business Administration Communication courses. Member, Student Conduct Board.
- Coursework in analytics and technology: Advanced Data Analytics, Machine Learning for Business and Finance, Forecasting in Finance and Economics, Python and Applications to Business Analytics, Information Visualization (Tableau), Credit Risk Analysis.
- Coursework in strategy and business: Competition and Strategy, Marketing Management, Business Dynamics, Business in Global Markets, Entrepreneurship and Rapid Prototyping, Business and Economic Strategies in Emerging Markets.

Hassenfeld Fellowship, Global Business Immersion

2023 to 2024

- Israel: visited Mobileye, Lemonade and Lightricks; explored artificial-intelligence-driven innovation and the Jerusalem and Tel Aviv technology ecosystems.
- India: engaged with Varun Beverages (Pepsi), Mahindra Group, ICICI Prudential, Welspun, Dabur and Bharti Airtel; visited the National Stock Exchange of India; studied the Unified Payments Interface and India Stack.

Namibia University of Science and Technology

2017

Bachelor of Engineering, Civil Engineering · Windhoek, Namibia

- Capstone project: water tower system design for Kalkrand township.
- International exchange: FH Aachen University of Applied Sciences, Germany (Project Management).
- Committee Member, Engineering Students Association.

DATA ANALYTICS AND RESEARCH PROJECTS

Machine Learning in Peer-to-Peer Lending

2024

- Analysed 1.8 million loan records with random forests and gradient boosting; identified the key drivers of default rates and returns and outperformed random selection strategies.

Time Series Analysis: AMD Stock Prices, 1984 to 2024

2024

- Applied autoregressive integrated moving average modelling and generalised autoregressive conditional heteroskedasticity volatility analysis to a 40-year dataset, with sentiment analysis of news and annual reports, to identify predictive factors.

COVID-19 Economic Impact Analysis

2024

- Analysed pandemic effects on rental markets across 458,177 Airbnb listings; quantified disruption, recovery patterns and policy response effectiveness.

Stripe Payment Processing Platform Analysis

2023

- Analysed the Southern African mobile payment market (M-Pesa, Flutterwave, Paystack) and Stripe's strategic deals and rationale for African expansion.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Python, R, Structured Query Language, JavaScript and TypeScript
Data and storage	PostgreSQL, Neo4j, SQLAlchemy, Supabase, Neon
Artificial intelligence and agents	Generative artificial intelligence, Claude, Scikit-learn, random forests and gradient boosting, time series modelling, sentiment analysis, retrieval-augmented generation, knowledge graphs, LangGraph, LlamaIndex, Pydantic artificial intelligence, CrewAI, AutoGen, anomaly detection, explainable artificial intelligence (Shapley values)
Product and platforms	Next.js, NestJS, FastAPI, React, React Native, Expo, web application programming interfaces, Android integration, Amazon Web Services, Google Cloud Platform, Vercel, Railway
Computer vision	OpenCV, MediaPipe, CVZone, YOLO, real-time vision agents
Security and governance	Governance, risk and compliance; cybersecurity risk awareness; National Institute of Standards and Technology Cybersecurity Framework literacy; Bank of Namibia Payment System Determination 12 operational and cyber controls; privacy-by-design and audit trails; model risk and data governance
Payments and regulation	Open Banking, NAMQR, Unified Payments Interface and India Stack, instant payment systems, cross-border interlinking, multi-central-bank digital currency settlement, programmable money, Banking Industry Architecture Network, payment service provider and e-money licensing literacy, regulatory sandboxes, government-to-person and biometric verification
Platforms and ecosystems	Platform and ecosystem business models, embedded finance, super apps, Open Banking data monetisation, regulatory technology, sustainability in fintech
Analytics and delivery	Financial modelling, forecasting, market research, data visualisation (Tableau), statistical and quantitative analysis, process optimisation, pitch and funding materials

VOLUNTEER AND COMMUNITY IMPACT

- **New Elementary Namibia:** collected and distributed educational materials, food and clothing for under-resourced schools; contributed to school refurbishment projects.
- **Global Entrepreneurship Network Namibia:** developed the "Zizza Makazi" green hydrogen concept for HDF Energy.

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Open Banking and Platforms in Finance Specialisation, Centre for Finance, Technology and Entrepreneurship (2023)

- Online Certificate for Fintech in Africa, Singapore Management University, Elevandi and the Centre for Finance, Technology and Entrepreneurship
- Rearchitecting the Financial System, Singapore Fintech Festival, Elevandi and the Centre for Finance, Technology and Entrepreneurship (2023)
- Operations Management, University of Cape Town (2021)
- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (candidate)
- Council member, Blockchain Association of Namibia (2026)
- Working towards: Amazon Web Services Cloud Practitioner, Amazon Web Services Artificial Intelligence Practitioner, governance, risk and compliance (cybersecurity track)